

Network & IT Vocabulary

Hardware, Software, Keyboard Shortcuts, IT Verbs & Troubleshooting

English for IT — ASIR/DAW · Inglés Profesional

Lesson Roadmap



1. Warm-up: Tech Brainstorm Sprint
2. Hardware vs. Software (basics)
3. Keyboard Vocabulary (basics)
4. Common IT Verbs (basics)
5. Phrasal Verbs (basics)
6. Hardware vs. Software (advanced)
7. Keyboard Shortcuts (advanced)
8. IT Verbs (advanced)
9. Phrasal Verbs (advanced)
10. Quick Practice: Gap-fill
11. Reading & Comprehension
12. True/False & Fill in the Gaps Practice
13. Computer Activity A: Diagnostics Lab
14. Computer Activity B: Report & Role-play
15. Wrap-up & Homework

Warm-up: Tech Brainstorm Sprint

5 min

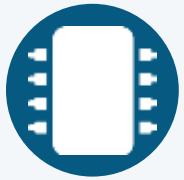


In pairs, you have 90 seconds to write down as many IT/tech words as you can remember from previous sessions (hardware, software, verbs, phrasal verbs...).

1. Pair up and set a 90-second timer.
2. Write as many tech words/expressions as possible — no looking at notes.
3. Stop. Count your words. The pair with the most words reads their list aloud.
4. Class discussion: which words are hardware, software, a verb or a phrasal verb?

Hardware vs. Software

5 min



HARDWARE

The physical parts of a computer — the components you can touch.

- CPU (processor)
- RAM (memory)
- Motherboard
- Hard drive / SSD
- Monitor, keyboard, mouse



SOFTWARE

The programs and instructions that tell the hardware what to do.

- Operating System (Windows, Linux)
- Applications (apps)
- Drivers
- Antivirus / security software

The Keyboard

5 min

Enter

Confirms an action / starts a new line

Shift

Types a capital letter or symbol

Ctrl

Used in shortcuts (Ctrl+C, Ctrl+V)

Alt

Used in alternate commands

Space Bar

Adds a space between words

Backspace

Deletes the character to the left

Caps Lock

Turns on capital letters

Tab

Moves the cursor / indents text

Esc

Cancels or exits an action

Arrow Keys

Move the cursor up/down/left/right

Function Keys (F1–F12)

Special commands (F1 = Help)

Delete

Removes the character to the right

Most Common Verbs in IT

5 min



install

Install the new application before you restart.



download

Download the driver from the manufacturer's website.



save

Save your work every few minutes.



delete

Delete temporary files to free up space.



click

Click the icon to open the program.



restart

Restart the computer to apply the update.



connect

Connect the laptop to the network.



type

Type your password and press Enter.

Phrasal Verbs and Technology

5 min



log in / log out

Log in with your username and password.



plug in / unplug

Plug in the charger before the battery dies.



set up

Set up the new printer in the office.



shut down

Shut down the PC before you leave.



back up

Back up your files to the cloud every week.

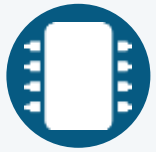


turn on / off

Turn on the router and wait one minute.

Hardware vs. Software — Going Deeper

10 min



HARDWARE

The physical, tangible components of a system that execute instructions.

Input devices:	keyboard, scanner, webcam
Output devices:	monitor, printer, speakers
Processing unit:	CPU, GPU, motherboard
Storage:	SSD/HDD, volatile RAM vs. non-volatile ROM
Peripherals:	external drives, docking stations



SOFTWARE

The instructions, data and programs that operate hardware and execute tasks.

System software:	operating system, drivers, firmware
Application software:	browsers, productivity suites
Utility software:	antivirus, disk-cleanup tools
Licensing model:	proprietary vs. open-source
Deployment:	installed locally vs. cloud-based

Keyboard Shortcuts (Key Combinations)

10 min

A modifier key (Ctrl, Alt, Shift, Windows) combined with another key triggers an advanced command.

Ctrl + Shift + Esc

Opens Task Manager directly

Ctrl + Alt + Del

Opens the security/options screen

Alt + Tab

Switches between open windows

Windows + L

Locks the computer

Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y

Undoes / redoes an action

Ctrl + Shift + T

Reopens the last closed tab

F5 / Ctrl + R

Refreshes the current page

Windows + Shift + S

Takes a screenshot of a selected area

Ctrl + Alt + T

Opens a terminal window (Linux)

Quick check (oral, no notes): the teacher calls out a function — you say the shortcut.

IT Verbs — Advanced Collocations

10 min

deploy

The team deployed the new configuration overnight.

configure

You must configure the firewall before going live.

troubleshoot

Troubleshoot the connection before escalating the ticket.

execute

Execute the script to update the database.

authenticate

Authenticate the user with two-factor verification.

allocate

Allocate more memory to the virtual machine.

overwrite

Don't overwrite the existing backup by mistake.

compile

Compile the source code before running any tests.

Phrasal Verbs — Advanced (with nuance)

10 min

set up

sep.

to install/configure — also “to arrange a meeting”: Set up the VPN connection.

roll back

sep.

to revert to a previous version: We had to roll back the update.

scale up / down

insep.

to increase/decrease resources: The company scaled up its server capacity.

run into

insep.

to encounter unexpectedly: We ran into a compatibility issue.

carry out

sep.

to perform/execute: Carry out a full system scan tonight.

back up

sep.

to make a copy: Back up the database before the migration.

crash / freeze up

insep.

to fail suddenly: The server crashed during peak hours.

look into

insep.

to investigate: IT is looking into the security breach.

Phrasal Verbs — Computer Actions (Part 1)

10 min

key in

sep.

to type/enter data: You have to key in the code to access the website.

boot up

insep.

to start a computer: It takes quite a while for this computer to boot up.

power up / turn on

sep.

to provide power to a machine: Press the button to power up your tablet.

go down

insep.

to stop working/crash: The computer system is always going down; we need a new one.

pull down

sep.

to open a drop-down menu: Look for the File menu and pull down to Save as.

print out

sep.

to send an electronic document to a printer: I have to print out the directions before I leave home.

Phrasal Verbs — Computer Actions (Part 2)

10 min

wipe out

sep.

to completely erase or delete files: Before you donate your computer, wipe out the hard drive.

filter out

sep.

to remove unwanted email messages: Can we filter out all the spam on this account?

opt in / out

insep.

to choose to receive (or not) ads or messages: The company asked me to opt in to get special offers by email.

scroll up / down

insep.

to move the cursor or text up/down: Use the mouse wheel to scroll up and down the screen.

log in / on

insep.

to start a session (verb): To log in requires you to provide credentials; you can log on without credentials.

login (noun)

n.

the username/password used to access an account: The password you use to access your account is your login.

Phrasal Verbs — Computer Actions (Part 3)

10 min

login (adjective)

adj.

used before a noun: You enter your password on the login page.

log in to / log into

insep.

usage note — “log in to” is generally preferred: I log in to my computer every day to check my email.

log out / off

insep.

to end a session: Don’t forget to log out when you’re done checking your email.

sign up

insep.

to register for the first time: If we want a free trial of the course we have to sign up.

sign in

insep.

to enter your username/password on an existing account: Every time I want to check my email I have to sign in.

pop up

insep.

to appear suddenly: I hate it when ads keep popping up.

Quick Practice: Fill in the Gaps

Individually, complete each sentence with a verb or phrasal verb from today. Compare with a partner — no answer key.

1. Before updating the system, make sure to _____ all important files.

2. If an app stops responding, press _____ to open Task Manager.

3. The technician had to _____ the network issue for over an hour.

4. We _____ a serious bug during the last testing phase.

5. Please _____ the router before connecting any new devices.

6. The company decided to _____ its cloud storage capacity.

7. IT is currently _____ the cause of the security breach.

8. The failed update had to be _____ immediately.

Reading: Network Incident Report



Last Friday, something went wrong with the company network. The sales department reported a serious problem: none of their terminals could log in or authenticate on the network. This meant that nobody in that department could use their computers to work.

A junior technician was asked to troubleshoot the problem right away. He had just configured a new firewall rule that morning, so he checked his own work first. Then he ran several diagnostic tests to find out what was really happening.

After a few minutes, he found the real cause. The DHCP server had run out of available IP addresses. This happens when more devices are connected to the network than the system expects. In this case, more devices had been allocated an address than planned, so no addresses were left for the new terminals.

The technician had two options. He could restart the entire system, but that would take a long time and stop everyone from working. Or he could fix the specific problem instead. He decided not to restart everything. Instead, he rolled back the firewall rule that had caused the conflict, and he scaled up the address pool so there would be more IP addresses available.

Once this change had been deployed, the terminals could authenticate again within minutes, and everyone in the sales department was able to log in and continue working.

Later, the technician wrote a formal report about the incident. He explained what had happened and what he had done to fix it. He also recommended that the IT team carry out a full network audit — checking the whole network carefully — before they try to scale up the infrastructure any further in the future.

Comprehension questions

1. What problem was reported, and by which department?
Nobody could authenticate on the network. Sales department

2. Why couldn't the DHCP server assign new IP addresses?

Because it had run out of DHCP addresses

3. What does the technician's decision to “roll back” rather than restart tell you about his approach?

It shows a practical approach to solving the issue while minimizing downtime

4. Find a phrase in the text that means “to check something using tests.”

run tests / troubleshoot

6. What does the final report recommend, and why does the text suggest this matters?
It recommends that the IT team carry out a full audit before they try to scale up…

Check Your Understanding

10 min

True or False?

Based on the reading, decide if each statement is true or false.

1. The problem was first reported by the IT department. True / False: ____

2. The technician had configured a new firewall rule earlier that morning. True / False: ____

3. The DHCP server ran out of addresses because too many devices had been given one. True / False: ____

4. The technician solved the problem by restarting the whole system. True / False: ____

5. The final report recommended carrying out a full network audit. True / False: ____

Fill in the Gaps

firewall | terminals | audit | DHCP server | deployment

1. The sales department's _____ could not authenticate on the network.

2. The technician had just configured a new _____ rule that morning.

3. The _____ had run out of available IP addresses.

4. Once the _____ was complete, the terminals could authenticate again.

5. The IT team was asked to carry out a full network _____.

Computer Activity A: Diagnostics Lab

15 min

1 **Task Manager**

Press Ctrl+Shift+Esc. Identify current CPU, memory and disk usage. Write 2 sentences describing performance (e.g. “The system is currently allocating 62% of available RAM.”).

2 **Command Prompt**

Open Command Prompt and run ipconfig /all. Record, in English, at least 4 items: IP address, subnet mask, default gateway, DNS server.

3 **Connectivity test**

Run ping google.com. Describe the result in a full sentence using authenticate, troubleshoot or configure.

Computer Activity B: Report & Role-play

10 min

4 **Incident report**

Individually, write a short report (80–100 words) based on your diagnostics: Problem → Actions taken → Result → Recommendation. Use at least 4 words/phrasal verbs from today.

5 **Phone role-play**

In pairs (2 minutes): Student A is the technician reporting the incident; Student B is the IT manager asking follow-up questions. Use the vocabulary naturally.

Wrap-up & Homework

5 min



Quick recap

The teacher cold-calls 3–4 students: each shares one new word or expression learned today and uses it in a sentence.



Homework

- Finish the incident report if not completed in class.
- Review today's verbs, phrasal verbs and shortcuts — short vocabulary check next session.
- Bring one real IT term (from a manual, app or website) you didn't understand, to discuss next class.